Programme brochure

The CareLeaders Fellowship

A 12-month leadership programme for anyone over 18 who is care experienced or works with care experienced people.

Fellows build their idea, then launch it at The Care Leaders Summit.

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The CareLeaders Fellowship

Why we created it

Plenty of good ideas for care experienced people never get past the first year.

The people behind them are care experienced themselves, or work alongside care experienced people every day. They know what needs to change. What they rarely get is the time, the structure and the people around them to make an idea last.

So ideas stay dependent on one person, and stall. The Fellowship gives them a year, and a framework that takes an idea from the story behind it to who will lead it next.

That's why we created The Care Leaders Fellowship.

The gap

01 **No time**

The people behind good ideas rarely get time away from the day job to work on them.

02 **No structure**

There is no plan to work to, and no one asking what happens next.

03 **No network**

They are building alone, without people doing the same thing to learn from.



What it is

A 12-month leadership programme for people building something for care experienced people. Fellows turn an idea into a project or business, then launch it at The Care Leaders Summit.

1

Apply

Tell us about you and your idea. We meet every applicant.

→

2

Build it

Twelve months working through the Five S framework, with two retreats and a session every month.

→

3

Launch it

Present your project or business at The Care Leaders Summit, to councils from across the country.

→

4

Take it further

Follow up the conversations from the Summit, with the Fellowship network behind you.



The Fellow profile

Who joins, and what it takes.

18+

Age
With no upper age limit

12

Months
One cohort a year

4

Hours a month
Including a two-hour online session

2

Retreats
Four days each, away from the day job

Who it is for

Lived and professional experience in the same room.

Each cohort brings together people from across the country who are building something for care experienced people.

Who you are

People with care experience
Already making a difference for care experienced people, and ready to make it last.

People who work alongside them
Building something for care experienced people, from a new service to a project they lead.

What you bring

An idea, project or business that solves a problem for care experienced people. It doesn't need to be polished. You bring lived experience of care, professional experience of working alongside it, or both.

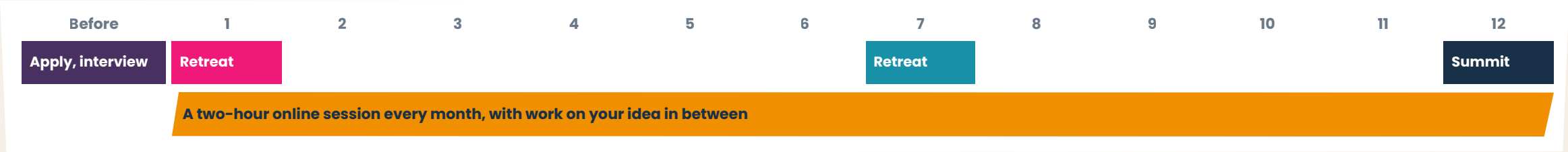
What it asks

Time away from the day job for both retreats, a two-hour online session each month, and time to work on your idea in between.

> **It enabled me to see how other stakeholders would look at my business, but also how to address them.**
>
> **Carl Moreton**, My Future Self Matters, Fellow of The Care Leaders Fellowship

Twelve months, from first idea to launch.

Two four-day retreats and a two-hour online session each month, with work on your idea in between. The year ends at The Care Leaders Summit, where fellows launch their work. A new cohort starts each year.



1

Before you start

Apply

Tell us about you and the idea you want to work on.

→

2

Before you start

Interview

We meet every applicant, then confirm places.

→

3

Month 1

Retreat one

Four days to meet your cohort and start the Five S framework.

→

4

Months 1 to 12

Every month

A two-hour online session with your cohort, and work on your idea in between.

→

5

Month 7

Retreat two

Four days to take the work further and plan your launch at the Summit, including pitch training.

→

6

End of the year

The Summit

Launch your work at The Care Leaders Summit, to councils from across the country.

The Five S framework

Five stages, worked through in order.

The Five S framework is the curriculum. The retreats and monthly sessions take you through the five stages in order, from the story behind your idea, through its launch at the Summit, to who will lead it next.



S1 Storytelling

Why it matters

How to tell the story of your idea, and your own story if you choose to, so funders, partners and the people you want to reach understand why it matters.

You work on

- The story behind your idea
- Who it is for and what changes for them
- Telling it in a pitch, a post or a meeting

S2 Skills

What you need to lead it

The entrepreneurial and leadership skills to move an idea forward, and an honest look at the skills you have and the ones you need to find.

You work on

- Your strengths as a leader
- The gaps, and who could fill them
- Leading other people

S3 Strategies

How it will work

Turning an idea into a plan: who it is for, how it will reach them, and how it will be paid for.

You work on

- Your plan for the next year
- How the idea is funded
- Partners who can help
- Planning your launch at the Summit

S4 Scaling or sustaining

Launch it, then decide how it grows

You launch your work at The Care Leaders Summit. From there, you decide whether to grow it or keep it running well where it is.

You work on

- Launching at the Summit
- Choosing your route
- What growing or keeping it going would need

S5 Succession planning

Make it last

Planning for the work to carry on without depending on one person, including you.

You work on

- Who could lead it next
- Writing down how it works
- A plan for handing on



Luke Rodgers BEM
Founder and CEO, The Care Leaders

Your facilitator

From care leaver to care leader.

Luke went into care at 10. At 15 he was living in a bed and breakfast, and at 18 in a caravan. He gave his first keynote at 19 and has spent his career since inside children's services, as a consultant, trainer, board member and national engagement lead.

He has built what fellows are setting out to build. He founded The Care Leaders in 2017 and grew it from one idea into a consultancy that has worked with 36 local authorities and national bodies, including the Department for Education and the NHS. Alongside it he built The Care Leaders Online, Luke Speaks and The Care Leaders Fellowship CIC, founded the Care Leavers National Movement, and brought councils, charities and businesses together at The Care Leaders Summit.

He led the national engagement on the Department for Education's rewrite of the Fostering Services National Minimum Standards, and has been a non-executive director of The Staff College. He knows what councils look for when they partner with, pilot or commission something new, because he has made that case himself many times.

- **Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award**
  iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026
- **British Empire Medal**
  2018, for commitment to children and families
- **Knowledge Equity Fellow**
  Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, 2020 to 2021
- **Social Entrepreneur Fellow**
  School for Social Entrepreneurs, 2015 to 2017

The CareLeaders Fellowship

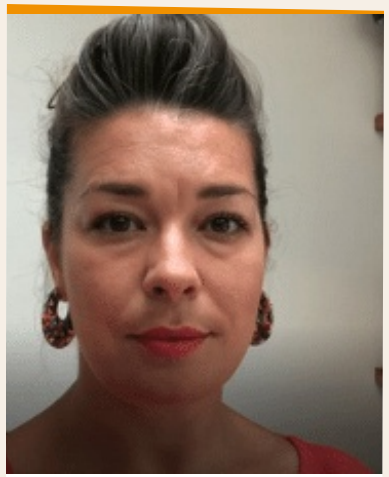
People fellows learn from

Some of the people fellows have learned from.

Alongside Luke, fellows learn from leaders in children's services, business and social enterprise, and from Fellows who have done it themselves. Guests change each year. These are facilitators and speakers from past cohorts.



Kathy Evans
Children England
Session Organising for a purpose, and how systems change



Dez Holmes
Research in Practice
Session Being evidence-informed when you are trying to change the world



Dave Linton
Founder, Madlug
Session An introduction to social entrepreneurship



Sir John Timpson
Timpson
Session Upside down management

Also from past cohorts

Professor Maggie Atkinson
Former Children's Commissioner for England
Session Human first leadership

Dr Janet Rose
Norland
Session Emotion coaching

Jerome Harvey-Agyei
Fellow, Topé Project
Session The story of building Topé

Beth Bradshaw
Founder, House of Participation, and a Fellow
Session Retreat facilitator

At a glance

The Fellowship in numbers.

12 **Months**
With a new cohort each year

2 **Retreats**
Four days each, away from the day job

12 **Online sessions**
Two hours each, one a month

5 **Stages**
The Five S framework

1 **Summit**
Where fellows launch their work

The support around you

Everything you need to get your idea ready to launch.

A cohort
Fellows working on the same kind of problem, who meet at every retreat and session and keep in touch in between.

The learning programme
The Five S framework, taught at the two retreats and the monthly online sessions.

Entrepreneurial coaching
Coaching to move your idea from a plan to something ready to launch.

Digital marketing incubator
Help to create your own content, from blogs, video and podcasts to social media and a website.

Fundraising support
Pitch training, and help to find funders and make the case to them.

A launch at the Summit
A place at The Care Leaders Summit to present your work to councils from across the country.

At the end of the Fellowship, you launch your work at The Care Leaders Summit.

We bring councils from across the country into the room to meet you, hear your idea and talk about what could happen next.





What fellows leave with

Launched, and connected to the councils who could use it.

- Their project or business, launched at The Care Leaders Summit
- Introductions to councils from across the country
- A pitch and a story ready for commissioners and funders
- A plan for the next year, including how the work is funded
- Their own content and a presence online for the work
- A plan for who leads the work next
- A place in the Fellowship network

What changes

Beyond the fellows themselves.

01 **For the work.** Projects and businesses that can carry on without depending on one person.

02 **For councils.** A chance to meet new ideas early, and to partner with, pilot or commission the ones that fit.

03 **For care experienced people.** More good ideas turned into projects and businesses that last.

04 **For children's social care.** New ideas from people with lived and professional experience, tried in practice.

Former fellows

The people who have been through it.

Fellows come from care, from social work, from youth work and from business. Here are a few of them, and what they built.



Mary-Anne Hodd

Vital Voice

Training, keynotes and consultancy that change how adults understand children in care. Launched with the Fellowship's support.



Carl Moreton

My Future Self Matters

Peer mentoring and workshops for children with care experience in Buckinghamshire, now delivered under contract.



Jerome Harvey-Agyei

The Topé Project

Reducing loneliness for care leavers, starting with a Christmas Day event in 2012, and training for the people who support them.



Jade Barnett

Power2Prevail Community

Co-founder, speaker and consultant working to improve outcomes for care leavers, and a former member of the Mayor of London's Violence Reduction Unit Young People's Action Group.



Beth Bradshaw

House of Participation

Built House of Participation from an idea into a business, with the Fellowship's advice and guidance.

In their words

The Fellowship supported me from my initial ideas phase through to launching; they've been critical in the success of my business.

Mary-Anne Hodd, CEO, Vital Voice Ltd
Fellow of The Care Leaders Fellowship, 2023

"The fellowship has provided me with the advice and guidance I needed to develop my business from an idea into reality."
Beth Bradshaw, Founder, House of Participation

Fellows leading elsewhere

Lee Weston

A Care Leaders Fellow, co-hosted Liverpool Virtual School's Rising Futures conference.

Fellows at the Summit

Many of the talks and workshops at the last Summit were led by Fellows, including a live recording with The Relational Social Work Podcast.

Earlier cohorts

Fellows have used the programme to launch training and consultancy businesses, and a participation champions programme in Liverpool.

The CareLeaders Fellowship

Find out how to apply

Your idea could be launching at the next Summit.

1 Get in touch

Email us, or scan the QR code, and we will tell you when applications open.

2 Apply

Tell us about you and the idea you want to work on.

3 Interview

We meet every applicant, then confirm places in the next cohort.

hello@thecareleaders.com · 0800 233 5597

Scan to find out how to apply

Leave your details and we will tell you when applications open.

Questions people ask

When does it start?

A new cohort starts each year. Get in touch to find out when we are opening applications.

Can my employer support me to take part?

Yes. We can share an agreement with your employer that sets out the time you need for the retreats.

What happens after the year?

Fellows stay part of the Fellowship network, and keep working on the conversations started at the Summit.

iese Awards GOLD Winner 2026 The Public Sector Transformation Awards

Children & Young People Now Awards 2023 Winner

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.
Children & Young People Now Workforce Development Award 2023.

The Care Leaders Fellowship CIC, company number 11879929